Incident Report INC-2026-0217: Card authorisation latency

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Date: 2026-02-17
Status: Final

Summary

On 2026-02-17 between 09:10 and 10:25 UTC, card authorisations were slow because our acquiring partner NetAcq had a degradation in its authorisation service. Kestrel Pay systems were healthy; payment-gateway was waiting on NetAcq responses.

Impact

- Severity: SEV-3
- About 2,300 card payments took longer than 10 seconds.
- No payments failed; the merchant-api timeout of 30 seconds was not reached.

Affected services

- payment-gateway: slow responses from the upstream dependency NetAcq
- merchant-api: slower Checkout API responses

Root cause

External: a degradation of the NetAcq authorisation service, confirmed by the NetAcq status page. No Kestrel Pay change was involved.

Follow-up

- Evaluate a secondary acquiring partner for failover. Owner: Lea Brandt.